

A Public $\text{\LaTeX}$ Template for *Econ Journal Watch*

Making article production easier —
for authors, and for Dan



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What I'll Cover

1. The problem with how we build articles today
2. What `ejw.cls` actually is (no jargon, I promise)
3. Seeing it work, side by side
4. What changes for you — and what doesn't
5. How we roll it out

Ten minutes of slides, then I'd much rather hear your questions.

The Problem Today

Right now, an accepted article travels a long road before it looks like *EJW*:

- Authors are asked to write and submit in **Word**.
- Production staff retypes or reformats it by hand into house style.
- Every rule is applied *manually*: fonts, margins, headings, footnote numbering, reference style.
- That means real staff time on every article, and real risk of a stray typo or a missed italic.

The question

Can the computer remember the house style, so a person doesn't have to — every time?

What Is a “Class File”?

*Think of `ejw.cls` as a Word template
that never forgets the house rules.*

Author controls substance; class file controls appearance.

The author supplies

- Title, name, text
- Footnotes
- Figures and tables
- References

The class file supplies

- Page size, margins, fonts
- Headings, running heads, footers
- Quotations, captions
- Reference style, live links

This is a production tool, not a push toward equations. It changes how the file is built, not what *EJW* publishes.

How It Works



- Change a rule once, in the class file, and **every** article that uses it updates.
- Today, changing a rule means changing it in every article, one at a time.

Same article. Two different production systems.

Discuss this article at JournalTalk:
<https://journaltalk.net/articles/>



ECON JOURNAL WATCH 25(3)
March 2025: 327-334

Article Title

Author Name¹

[LINK TO ABSTRACT](#)

This is the introduction of the article. It typically doesn't have a section header, and the author will go on a bit here. Note that, for the final PDF, we don't include the abstract, keywords, and JEL codes. Those go on the website.² For even pages, we have the header be the author's last name, as all caps. For the odd pages, we have the header be a shortened version of the title of the article. For example, if the title of the article is "Cry Wine and Sell Vinegar: Reposider to Mao and Wang," a good short title for the header would be "Reposider to Mao and Wang."

Section Header

Above is what a section header is. Note that we **don't** number our headers at this journal.

Subsection header

If applicable, above is what a subsection header looks like. In the below text, you will see what a quote looks like in EJW styling.

This is what a quotation looks like in EJW styling.

Below is how a list is formatted. Whether the list is numbered or not depends on the article.

1. Item one;
2. Item two;

¹ Author affiliation.

² This is how a footnote should be formatted. Note the space at the beginning of the footnote.

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Max's in-house system
Public class matches in-house page geometry, title block, headings, and footnotes.
ejw.cls — public, author-editable
What's left (list style, table rules) is an explicit editorial choice.

It Works on Real Articles, Too

Discuss this article at JournalTalk:
<https://journaltalk.net/articles/>



ECON JOURNAL WATCH XX(X)
Month 20XX: 1–XX

Where Credit is Due

Alexis Akira Toda¹

[LINK TO ABSTRACT](#)

How is it that an essential preceding article of 1998, published in a leading field journal, goes unrecognized by the authors of the 2006 and 2011 papers that reach remarkably similar conclusions? And, how is it that the 1998 article is neglected while the 2011 article is cited more than ten times as often?

The succeeding paper is Jess Benhabib, Alberto Alesina, and Shenghao Zhu (2011) (henceforth BBZ), together with an earlier unpublished manuscript of Benhabib and Alesina (2006) (henceforth BB). Both study overlapping generations economies in which each household saves, consumes, and leaves a bequest to the next generation, and in which luck—in the return a generation earns on its wealth, or in how long it lives to accumulate—varies from one generation to the next. Both papers show that this combination delivers a stationary wealth distribution with a Pareto upper tail: a small number of very rich dynasties, with the frequency of wealth levels declining according to a power law rather than tapering off exponentially. The appeal is that the fat tail is not assumed: it emerges from optimizing behavior plus repeated multiplicative shocks. BBZ is influential by any measure: cited over 600 times on Google Scholar as of August 2026, and a fixture of the wealth inequality literature that flourished after Thomas Piketty (2014).

The preceding paper is Jayanti Dutta and Philippe Michel (1998) (henceforth DM), which reached the same conclusions eight years earlier than the 2006 version and 13 years earlier than the 2011 article. Jayanti Dutta passed away in 2021,² and Philippe Michel passed away in 2004.³ In the model of DM, time is discrete, a household in a dynasty lives for one period, and *may or may not* be altruistic with some probability. When a household is selfish, it consumes all wealth. If altruistic, it solves an optimal consumption-saving problem, which determines the

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² <https://www.econ.cam.ac.uk/news/2021/professor-jayanti-dutta-obituary>

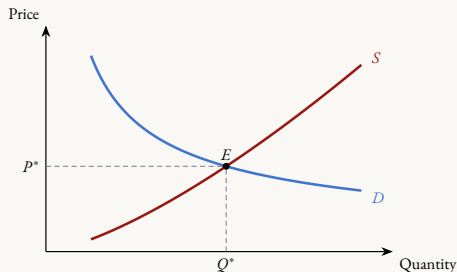
³ [https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Philippe_Michel_\(economist\)](https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Philippe_Michel_(economist))

This isn't just a mockup.

A real, 15-page manuscript — fully typeset in `ejw.cls`, start to finish:

- Title page, abstract, sections
- Footnotes and long quotations
- Full bibliography with clickable links and DOIs
- Author biography page

Figures, Tables, and References



A vector figure, drawn once, always crisp

- Handled automatically, with no extra author effort.
- Figures and tables get EJW-style captions.
- Clean booktabs tables — fewer rules, less clutter.
- Citations, web addresses, and DOIs become **clickable** on screen.

No Software to Install

Overleaf puts $\text{\LaTeX}$ in a web browser.

1. Open the EJW template on Overleaf
2. Click “Open as Template”
3. Replace the sample text with your paper
4. Click **Recompile**

No installation. No command line. Free plan is enough.



Scan: “Learn $\text{\LaTeX}$ in
30 Minutes” (Overleaf)

Why This Helps Everyone

1. **Less burden on authors** — focus on the argument, not the formatting.
2. **Faster, safer production** — reuse the source instead of retyping it.
3. **A wider submission pool** — no separate Word conversion required.
4. **Better online reading** — citations, DOIs, and links become clickable.
5. **More consistent issues** — one set of rules, applied every time.

What Does *Not* Change

This is an **optional** route.
Word submissions are still fully welcome.

- This is a **production** proposal, not an effort to make *EJW* more mathematical.
- Nobody is required to learn $\text{\LaTeX}$.
- The *EJW* look and editorial voice don't change — only how the file gets built.

A Low-Risk Rollout

1. Approve the public template after one final visual review.
2. Publish it in the Overleaf Template Gallery and link it from the EJW submission page.
3. Keep accepting every existing format — $\text{\LaTeX}$ is an added option, not a replacement.
4. Pilot it on one issue, collect corrections, and refine the class once.

Most of the work is already done. The payoff: easier submissions, faster production, fewer errors, more consistent issues, better digital reading.

Everything shown today — the class file, template, user guide, and sample article — is now live on the EJW website.



Overleaf



Style guide (LaTeX option)



My website

It's official — download it directly from econjwatch.org.

Thank You

Questions, pushback, and “that will never work” welcome.

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